

China advanced manufacturing tour

EQUITY: TECHNOLOGY

Takeaways from Unitree visit ahead of its listing

Full-stack cost lead intact; however, model capability and B-end breadth still unproven, as per management

Management: Profitable humanoid player cleared for STAR Market on full-stack cost advantage

We visited Unitree (unlisted), a global leader in high-performance general-purpose humanoid and quadruped robots, on 15 June 2026. On 1 June, its STAR (Sci-Tech Innovation Board) IPO was cleared by the SSE (Shanghai Stock Exchange) Listing Review Committee. According to the company, Unitree plans to issue 40.44mn shares to raise CNY4.2bn. In 2025, its humanoid shipments topped 5,500 units, ranking first globally, while revenue rose 335% y-y to CNY1.7bn and net profit reached CNY288mn. According to management, the company recorded c.60% gross margin and a 90%+ production-and-sales ratio, underpinned by a full-stack in-house model in which motors, reducers and LiDAR are self-developed, and purchased components contribute only c.14-18% of total cost. Management characterises mature quadruped cash flows as funding humanoid R&D and market expansion.

Brain barrier: The sector's binding bottleneck beyond motion control

According to an external industry survey, Unitree leads globally in motion control; however, the binding constraint instead sits in the "brain" (e.g. the world model) - a general-purpose technology. Crucially, the dominant model roadmap has not yet converged: leading researchers have shifted from VLA-style (Vision-Language-Action Model) routes toward world models, yet definitions of the "world" and scene understanding still differ widely across players, according to the survey. With neither the high-level path nor its sub-routes settled, no confirmed timeline exists, as per the company's IPO prospectus. The industry survey, therefore, views hardware vendors will likely be exposed to gradual pressure by AI incumbents. Unitree management guides over 50% of IPO proceeds to be spent on brain development, which it believes will support the company's long-term development.

Beyond academia: Grid-inspection and firefighting scale, other verticals likely demand-pull, according to management

According to management, application areas remain the principal lever for the company's growth story. While 74% of humanoid revenue is still derived from universities and research institutes, demand beyond academia is also scaling quickly, with power-grid inspection and firefighting emerging as the fastest-growing industrial use cases, according to the IPO prospectus. Other verticals, however, are pursued largely on a demand-pull basis rather than proactively, helped by the company's positioning as a maker of general-purpose robots rather than scenario-specific machines, according to management. In addition, management indicated that it develops dedicated solutions for select segments only as market demand surfaces, likely also jointly with partners.

In the robotics supply chain, we have a Neutral rating on Tuopu (601689 CH), as we hold a cautious stance on the sustainability and scale of Tuopu's humanoid robot contributions, and expect its core business growth will decelerate in 2026F due to limited scale advantage.

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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Ningbo Tuopu Group	601689 CH	CNY 62.30	18-Jun-2026	Neutral	N/A	

Ningbo Tuopu Group (601689 CH)

CNY 62.30 (18-Jun-2026) Neutral (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)

Ningbo Tuopu Group



Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
14-Apr-26	Neutral		60.04
14-Apr-26		55.00	60.04
29-Aug-25		75.00	62.61
25-Jul-25	Buy		47.16
25-Jul-25		55.00	47.16

— Closing Price ▲ Target Price Change ● Recommendation Changes

Source: LSEG, Nomura

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology We use P/E method to value Tuopu and our TP of CNY55 is based on 34x 2026F P/E, at +1.5x SD of its historical average at 21x, which we believe is well supported by our 2025-28F earnings CAGR of 11%. The benchmark index is CSI300.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Upside risks include: 1) better-than-expected EV demand in China; and 2) faster mass production schedule from humanoid robot firms. Downside risks include: 1) lackluster shipment from key clients; and 2) slower mass production schedule from humanoid robot firms.

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As at 31 March 2026.

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